SHUOFEI ZAN

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Creativity-support tools / human–AI co-creation / behavioural evaluation of design guidance, exploration and autonomy

EDUCATION

Shaanxi University of Science and Technology **Sep 2024 – Jul 2027 (expected)**
Master's Degree Candidate in Design (full-time) | GPA 3.65/5.0; average 86.53/100

Shaanxi University of Science and Technology / Ulster University **Sep 2019 – Jun 2023**
BEng Industrial Design (SUST) | GPA 3.39/5.0; average 84.77/100
BSc (Hons) Design Engineering (Ulster University), First Class

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Sang, Z., **Zan, S.**, Li, L., Fu, X., Liu, Z., Chen, D., Yuan, X., & Shi, P. (2025). Comparative study on the color characteristics of sky-green porcelain in the four kilns of a Ru kiln system from the Northern Song Dynasty. *Open Ceramics, 23*, 100821. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.oceram.2025.100821

Sang, Z., Chen, D., Wang, X., **Zan, S.**, Yuan, X., Sang, Y., & Fu, X. (2026). Authenticity identification of the "golden threads and iron wires" patterns of Southern Song Ge ware. *China Ceramics, 62*(5), 102–112. https://doi.org/10.16521/j.cnki.issn.1001-9642.2026.05.012 [in Chinese]

Sang, Z., **Zan, S.**, & Chen, D. (2026). Modelling proportion rules for ceramic outlines and their interactive application. Accepted 31 Aug 2026; provisional English title.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Ceramic Form Modelling, Preference and Human Evaluation **2024–2026**

- Analysed 225 ceramic vessel outlines (165 historical; 60 contemporary) with PCA; the first two components captured 93.24% of profile variance.
- Compared Ridge and RBF-SVR preference models, deriving five interpretable proportion rules; separately reconstructed 60 Ru- and Yaozhou-related forms in Rhino.
- Conducted a 30-participant, 48-question two-alternative forced-choice study: rule-guided forms surpassed weak baselines but not highly rated real examples.
- Built a three-condition browser study (18 participants), logging acceptance, rejection, undo and task time; more guidance increased time without detected gains in rule alignment.

Ceramic Materials, Colour and Heritage Evidence **2024–2026**

- Interpreted XRF, XRD, Raman, SEM-EDS and XPS evidence for Ru-system, Longquan, Yaozhou and Ge-ware ceramics, connecting physical materials and visual judgements.
- Compared Tang-period and modern yellow glazes through composition and phase evidence; examined Jin-period moon-white glaze colour interpretations.

HoberGlow — Parametric Mechanism and Interactive Design **2025–2026**

- Designed a transformable scissor-linked lighting concept in Rhino/Grasshopper, exploring interaction through mechanism geometry and opening/closing motion.
- Developed exploratory optics comparisons and a reduced Karamba3D structural proxy; documented motion states and design alternatives.